



Tips & Tricks



A cat with a twist

We use *cat* to view a text file from beginning to end, right? Want to read a text file from the end to beginning? Use the *tac* command and see the difference.

—Rituraj Goswami, goswami.rituraj@gmail.com



Mount Windows share on Linux

So, you perhaps need to frequently access Windows from your Linux system. Most of you probably manually mount the partition every time you require it. Guess it's about time you append the following line in your */etc/fstab* file:

```
//Server/ShareName /home/ServerShare smb username=user,password  
=password 1 2
```

Of course, change the variables in the above line to the real values, the way it is in your case.

It would work in a home environment, where you don't mind putting the password in a */etc/fstab* file. If you want to be cautious, have a script ask for your password and mount the stuff using the *smbmount* command. However, if you would like to do this as the non-root user, specify the mount point option in */etc/fstab* along with the *noauto* and user options.

—Hemant Gangwar, heman.t021@gmail.com



Tracing symbolic links

Here is an easy way to trace the endpoint of a cascaded symbolic link—for example: */dev/cdrom*:

```
$ namei /dev/cdrom  
f: /dev/cdrom  
d /  
d dev  
l cdrom -> sr0
```

b sr0

...where, *f* is the path name we are currently trying to resolve, *d* means a directory, *l* means a symbolic link, and *b* means a block device. Check *man namei* for more details.

—Anish M P, anishparameswaran@gmail.com



Bash scripting string operations

To find the length of a string, we can use the following methods:

```
String="My India"  
Length=${#String}  
echo $Length
```

This will print 8.

Alternatively, we can also use *expr*:

```
Length=`expr length "$String"`
```

To find the position of a character or a sequence of chars in a string, we can use the *index* option in *expr*:

```
echo `expr index "$String" d`
```

The above will give the position of 'd' in the string.

To extract a sub-string from a string, we can use the following method:

```
$(string position:length)
```

For example:

```
echo $(String:3:5)
```

This will print 'India'.